

420 Eureka Street

SAN FRANCISCO 94114 · PROPERTY CONDITION REVIEW · PREPARED FOR A BUYER

Asking

\$1,995,000

Supported range \$2.6M – \$3.1M

80

OUT OF 100

Sound older home
Normal items, no
surprises

WHAT THE 289-PAGE PACKAGE SAYS, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

This is a well-kept 1940 San Francisco house that has had money spent on it recently and has no structural problems. The inspector's own summary calls it **serviceable condition**. There is no dry rot in the frame, no settlement, no drainage trouble, no code enforcement, and the building is **not** in the City's mandatory earthquake retrofit programme. What you are buying into is an ordinary older-home maintenance list: the original galvanised steel water pipes will need replacing one day, a number of outlets are not grounded, and the garage wall between the car and the house no longer meets today's fire standard. None of that is unusual, and none of it is a reason to walk.

Major problems

Typical older home

Turnkey

TO MAKE IT SAFE

\$9,400 – \$32,300

Electrical grounding and outlet protection, the garage fire wall and door, missing handrails, smoke and carbon-monoxide alarms, securing the range, servicing the fireplace

EVERYTHING ELSE, OVER TIME

\$22,500 – \$58,900

Repiping, roof and skylight attention, deck and soil work, tidy-up items. None of it urgent

ALL OPEN ITEMS

\$31,900 – \$91,200

About 1% to 3% of a purchase in the supported range

The three things that matter

1. The water pipes are the original galvanised steel

Galvanised pipe rusts from the inside. Water pressure drops, the water can run brown after the house sits empty, and eventually a joint gives way. The inspector flagged it and his own notes on older homes single this material out as the problematic one. [Home inspection 11.6.1](#)

What to do: budget **\$15,000 to \$30,000** to repipe the house. This is not an emergency and it will not stop the sale, but it is the biggest single number in the file and it belongs in your first-two-years plan, not your offer.

2. The electrics are 1940 in places

Several three-prong outlets are not actually grounded, which means an appliance plugged in cannot discharge a fault safely. Neither bathroom nor the garage has the shock-protection outlet (a GFCI) that modern code requires near water. Smoke and carbon-monoxide alarms are missing in one or more rooms. [Home inspection 4.7.1, 4.8.1, 6.10.1, 7.10.1, 12.6.1](#)

What to do: get an electrician to walk it before you write, if you can. The range is **\$5,000 to \$20,000**, and the width of that range is the point — it depends entirely on whether a ground wire already exists behind the walls. That single answer is worth more than any other piece of due diligence on this house.

3. The garage no longer separates from the house the way it should

The wall between the garage and the living space, and the door between them, do not meet the current fire-separation standard. Part of the garage wall has been covered in drywall, so the inspector could not see the framing behind it. There is also evidence of past water coming through the garage ceiling. [Home inspection 12.3.1, 12.5.1, 12.7.1 · Pest report Note B](#)

What to do: budget **\$3,000 to \$8,000**. A fire-rated door and drywall is routine work. Ask whether the ceiling leak was ever traced and fixed.

What is genuinely strong

- **No structural findings at all.** No settlement, no slippage, no soil problems, no fire or flood damage, no major repairs disclosed. *Transfer Disclosure Statement §C, 3 Sep 2026*
- **Not in the City's mandatory earthquake retrofit programme.** A meaningful cost other older San Francisco buyers are carrying. *3R report item 11A*
- **Energy and water compliance already done, certificate issued.** One less thing to fund at close. *3R report items 10A and 10B*
- **New Renewal by Andersen windows and exterior doors throughout,** with a 2021 permit on file. Windows are one of the largest deferred-maintenance items in a house of this age, and it is already handled. *Permit 202105140375*
- **No code enforcement, no abatement, no tax-board referral.** Nothing hanging over the property. *3R report items 8A and 8B*
- **The pest report is close to clean.** A single Section I finding: surface fungus under the stairs and porch, which the inspector states has *not* weakened the wood. *Pest report 3A, 8 Sep 2026*
- **Not in the City's 100-year storm flood area and not in a high fire-severity zone.** *3R item 12 · Natural Hazard Disclosure*

Every open item, grouped by urgency

ITEM, IN PLAIN TERMS	WHERE IT COMES FROM	LOW	HIGH
Safety — do these first, before or soon after you move in			
Ground the outlets, add shock-protection outlets in both bathrooms and the garage	Home inspection 4.8.1, 6.10.1, 7.10.1, 12.6.1 · scope depends on existing wiring	\$5,000	\$20,000
Fire-rated wall and door between the garage and the house	Home inspection 12.5.1, 12.7.1	\$3,000	\$8,000
Add graspable handrails to the stairs and exterior steps	Home inspection 3.6.1, 3.6.3, 4.10.1	\$800	\$2,500
Clean and service the fireplaces before first use	Home inspection 4.9.1	\$400	\$1,200
Secure the range so it cannot tip; refit the oven door	Home inspection 5.14.1, 5.14.2	\$200	\$600
Fit missing smoke and carbon-monoxide alarms	Home inspection 4.7.1 · included in the electrical line above	—	—
Safety subtotal		\$9,400	\$32,300
Known future — real costs, but on your timetable			
Replace the galvanised water supply pipes throughout	Home inspection 11.6.1	\$15,000	\$30,000
Rusting skylight frames and blocked roof drains on a flat roof	Home inspection 2.4.1, 2.5.1	\$1,500	\$6,000
Known-future subtotal		\$16,500	\$36,000
Elective — tidy-up and prevention, no urgency			
Lower the soil at the rear so wood and stucco are not sitting in dirt	Home inspection 3.3.1, 3.3.2 · Pest 4A	\$2,000	\$6,000
Deck and porch: stop the water getting in	Home inspection 3.6.2	\$1,200	\$5,500
Repair damaged flooring; ease the doors that stick	Home inspection 4.4.1, 4.5.1	\$1,000	\$5,000
Re-grout and reseal both bath and shower surrounds	Home inspection 6.13.1–2, 7.13.1–3 · Pest 4B	\$1,000	\$3,000
Treat the surface fungus under the stairs and porch	Pest report 3A, Section I	\$500	\$2,000
Re-grout the kitchen counter tile	Home inspection 5.9.1	\$300	\$1,400

ITEM, IN PLAIN TERMS	WHERE IT COMES FROM	LOW	HIGH
Elective subtotal		\$6,000	\$22,900
All open items — 30 findings, 20 recommendations, 10 safety		\$31,900	\$91,200

Figures are planning estimates for San Francisco trades prepared by McMullen Properties. They are not bids, quotes, or the inspector's opinion — neither report puts a dollar on anything. Get contractor numbers on the electrical and the repiping before you commit.

One thing to ask about, which is not a defect

The lower level was permitted in 1972 as a sewing room

The City's building record shows a permit from February 1972 to break the concrete for legal headroom, frame three walls and install a bathroom downstairs — described on the permit as a room to be used as a sewing room. Today that level is marketed as a third bedroom, a lounge and a second bathroom. 3R report, permit 405890 · Vanguard Non-Conformity Advisory

Keep this in proportion. Lower-level space that outgrew its original permit is the baseline condition for period San Francisco housing, not a defect, and it should not be priced as one. The seller states there is no unpermitted work and no zoning violation. Transfer Disclosure Statement §C4, C5, C10

Still worth one written question, because it affects how the house compares to others: is the lower level permitted habitable space, is the third bedroom legal, and does the approximately 1,365 square feet include it? A floor plan is in the package. If the bedroom count softens, so does the comparison to other three-bedroom sales.

What this means for your offer

OFFER	PER SQ FT	OF ASKING	ALL-IN WITH \$62,000 OF WORK	HOW TO READ IT
\$2,600,000	\$1,904.76	130.3%	\$2,662,000	Bottom of the supported range
\$2,850,000	\$2,087.91	142.9%	\$2,912,000	Midpoint, and it matches what the four comparable sales averaged
\$3,100,000	\$2,271.06	155.4%	\$3,162,000	Top. Equal to what 145 Grand View paid — a house with a view and nearly three times the lot
\$3,175,000	\$2,326.01	159.1%	\$3,237,000	The hardest overbid in the set. Above what this house supports

The repair list will not win you a discount here

All four comparable sales closed above their asking price, averaging 140% of it in eight days. Two were listed at exactly \$1,995,000 — the same number as this listing — and closed at \$3,175,000 and \$3,100,000. In that kind of market a condition list is not a bargaining chip.

Use it the other way round. Take your maximum, subtract what the work will cost you, and let the remainder be your bid. Deduct from your ceiling, not from your offer.

You are not being pushed to waive inspections

The seller's own offer instructions say the seller and listing agents invite any and all inspections, and that buyers are **not** encouraged to waive inspections as a tactic for winning. That is unusual and it is in your favour: it suggests a fully informed offer can compete here without you taking on blind risk. Offer instructions, disclosure package cover

The other number nobody mentions: your tax bill

The seller bought in March 2012 for \$890,000 and is assessed on that basis. He pays **\$13,946** a year. Your assessment resets to what you pay.

At \$2,850,000 the first-year property tax is roughly **\$35,554**, before the City's separate direct assessments. That is about **\$1,800 more per month** than the current owner pays, and it starts the day you close. [Public tax history](#) · rate implied by the current bill, 1.2475%

Six things to ask in writing, before the offer date

QUESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
Does a ground wire already run to the outlets, or does the house need rewiring?	It is the difference between the \$5,000 end and the \$20,000 end of the largest safety line.
Is the lower level permitted habitable space, and is the third bedroom legal?	The 1972 permit authorised a sewing room. Not a defect, but it changes how the house compares to other three-bedroom sales.
Does the approximately 1,365 square feet include the lower level, and what is it measured from?	A floor plan is in the package, and the package's own advisory says not to rely on advertised figures.
Is the 1,328 square foot lot size correct?	It is less than half the smallest comparable lot. The valuation turns on it.
Was the water that came through the garage ceiling ever traced and fixed?	Past moisture with no explanation is the one item in the file that could be bigger than it looks.
Is there a bid date, and will the seller look at offers early?	Five days on market, 674 views and 70 saves in the first eighteen hours. Your whole strategy follows the answer.

The bottom line

Condition is not the reason to hesitate on this house. A score of 80 puts it in the upper part of the normal band for a 1940 San Francisco home: no structural findings, no retrofit obligation, a near-clean pest report, and the windows already replaced. The open list is long in item count and modest in money — roughly 1% to 3% of the purchase price, with under a third of it genuinely urgent.

The two numbers that could move are the electrical and the repiping. One electrician's walkthrough before the offer date would tighten a \$25,000 spread down to a figure you can actually plan around.

Everything else about this decision is about price, not condition. The comparable evidence says a winning bid here sits between \$2.6M and \$3.1M. Pick your ceiling, take the repair budget off it, and bid the difference.

Seller	Not occupying the property	Building record	3R issued 21 Jul 2026, expires 21 Jul 2027
Block / lot	2767 / 001C	Zoning / use	RH-2; authorised use one-family dwelling
Home inspection	Golden Gate Home Inspections, 8 Sep 2026, 72 pages	Pest inspection	CoreSpect / Fox Structural, 8 Sep 2026
Package	289 pages, 46 documents, compiled 11 Sep 2026	Escrow	First American Title

Prepared from the seller's disclosure package for 420 Eureka Street, compiled 11 September 2026. Findings are summarised from the Report of Residential Building Record (3R), the California Real Estate Transfer Disclosure Statement, the home inspection, the wood destroying pests and organisms report and the Natural Hazard Disclosure. The property condition score is McMullen Properties' own measure of physical condition relative to comparable period housing; it is not a warranty and not an inspection. Cost figures are planning estimates, not bids or quotes. This sheet is a summary and is not a substitute for reading the full package or commissioning your own inspections. Not an appraisal, a construction estimate, legal advice or tax advice.